

Hiwin Corp. (2049.TW): Price hikes outpace cost increases, raising market share erosion risk; reiterate Sell

What surprised us?

Hiwin reported its 2Q26 result after the close on Aug 12th. The core business (OPI) was 22%/9% higher than GSe and BBG consensus, with GM coming in 1.6ppt higher than GSe mainly due higher UTR (especially for LG business) and better pricing on core products (LG also see price increase in 2Q26). Opex was higher than expected (NT\$1,531mn in 2Q26 vs. GSe at NT\$1,428mn). For earnings, Hiwin's 2Q26 net income was 22%/10% higher than GSe/BBG consensus, mainly due to the GM expansion driven by better pricing and higher UTR.

Moreover, the company's overall order lead time has improved to 4-6 months for some products, with BS at 6 months (was 4.5-5 months previously) and the company is also seeing some orders extended into 1Q27 while LG is at 4 months (was ~3.5 months previously), compared to 3 months previously, mainly driven by recovery in China market, which continue to be supported by government policy.

Earnings analysis and revisions

Hiwin's 2Q26 core business (OPI) was 22%/9% higher than GSe and BBG consensus due to higher UTR as well as some positive impact from pricing. GM was 1.6/1.0ppt higher than GSe/BBG consensus in 2Q26. For net income, it was 22%/10% higher than GSe/BBG consensus due to better-than-expected GM.

We maintain our bearish view on the outlook for the linear motion industry, and do not expect a significant recovery in demand across most end applications (excluding semiconductor industry). However, we revise up our 2026E revenue to factor in 2Q26 results and revise down 2027/28E revenue estimates by 8/9% to factor in reduced inventory pull-in effects, and revise up our 2026/27/28E GM estimate by 2.1/1.4/1.0ppt as we expect the margin expansion is driven by inflation, where we expect the company can pass on the increased costs through price hike. We also introduce our 2029E estimates in this report.

Investment view

We reiterate our Sell rating on the stock, based on (1) intensifying competition from Chinese local suppliers, including AirTAC, which continues to maintain a stable pricing strategy amid rising material costs (see [here](#)), while Hiwin has raised prices across its core products (including both BS and LG), potentially leading to market share erosion, (2) no clear signs of a recovery in consumer electronics, which could result in softer orders in 2H26, as some demand may have been front-loaded into

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1H26 ahead of the price hikes, (3) continued R&D investment in new semiconductor and logistics system-level products, which we expect to keep OPEX elevated over the longer term and weigh on the GM outlook; and (4) current valuation level remains elevated (43.4x 1-year forward PE vs. average of 33.0x in the past 10 years), despite the lack of clear near-term growth catalysts.

Overall, we maintain our conservative view on Hiwin's core business (linear guide and ball screw) outlook, while seeing increasing cash flow risk from heavy investment in the semiconductor/logistics businesses, which we believe will have limited near-term contribution.

We maintain our Sell rating on Hiwin with a new 12m TP of NT\$160 (from NT\$143), based on an unchanged 20x P/E (in line with Hiwin's average downcycle valuation, or 1std lower than the historical average P/E for the past 10 years), but roll over our valuation base from 2H26-1H27E to 4Q26-3Q27E, and factor in our earnings revisions.

Exhibit 1: Hiwin 2Q26 comp table

Hiwin (2049.TW)	2Q26			QoQ		YoY		Bloomberg consensus	
P&L (NT\$mn)	Actual	GS est.	Diff (%)	1Q26	QoQ	2Q25	YoY	Consensus	%
Revenue	7,508	7,002	7%	6,379	18%	5,925	27%	7,374	2%
Gross profits	2,565	2,277	13%	2,037	26%	1,762	46%	2,446	5%
Operating profits	1,034	849	22%	631	64%	499	107%	947	9%
Pre-tax income	1,080	849	27%	719	50%	69	1475%	967	12%
Net earnings	848	694	22%	579	46%	135	527%	785	8%
EPS, NT\$	2.40	1.96	22%	1.64	46%	0.38	528%	2.19	10%
Gross margin (%)	34.2%	32.5%	1.6ppt	31.9%	2.2ppt	29.7%	4.4ppt	33.2%	1.0ppt
EBIT margin (%)	13.8%	12.1%	1.7ppt	9.9%	3.9ppt	8.4%	5.4ppt	12.8%	0.9ppt
Net margin (%)	11.3%	9.9%	1.4ppt	9.1%	2.2ppt	2.3%	9.0ppt	10.7%	0.6ppt

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Earnings revision table

Hiwin P&L (NT\$ mn)	2026E New	2026E Old	Diff.	2027E New	2027E Old	Diff.	2028E New	2028E Old	Diff.	2029E New
Sales	28,567	28,388	1%	29,134	31,503	-8%	31,210	34,444	-9%	33,808
Gross Profit	9,381	8,714	8%	9,407	9,734	-3%	10,261	10,987	-7%	11,222
EBIT	3,463	2,910	19%	3,767	3,698	2%	4,362	4,478	-3%	4,801
Net Income	2,859	2,379	20%	3,009	3,011	0%	3,466	3,614	-4%	3,804
EPS (NT\$)	8.08	6.72	20%	8.51	8.51	0%	9.80	10.22	-4%	10.75
Ratio analysis										
Gross margin	32.8%	30.7%	2.1pp	32.3%	30.9%	1.4pp	32.9%	31.9%	1.0pp	33.2%
EBIT margin	12.1%	10.2%	1.9pp	12.9%	11.7%	1.2pp	14.0%	13.0%	1.0pp	14.2%
Net margin	10.0%	8.4%	1.6pp	10.3%	9.6%	0.8pp	11.1%	10.5%	0.6pp	11.3%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: P&L table

NT\$m	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E	1Q28E	2Q28E	3Q28E	4Q28E	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Revenue	6,379	7,508	7,731	6,949	6,803	7,246	7,665	7,420	7,257	7,778	8,278	7,896	24,262	28,567	29,134	31,210	33,808
Gross profit	2,037	2,565	2,660	2,118	2,052	2,423	2,604	2,328	2,250	2,655	2,854	2,502	6,977	9,381	9,407	10,261	11,222
Operating expense	(1,407)	(1,531)	(1,500)	(1,480)	(1,361)	(1,391)	(1,441)	(1,447)	(1,361)	(1,463)	(1,527)	(1,548)	(5,335)	(5,918)	(5,640)	(5,898)	(6,420)
Operating income	630	1,034	1,160	638	691	1,032	1,163	881	889	1,192	1,328	954	1,643	3,463	3,767	4,362	4,801
Taxes expense	(170)	(263)	(267)	(147)	(173)	(227)	(256)	(211)	(222)	(262)	(292)	(229)	(354)	(847)	(867)	(1,005)	(1,106)
Minority interest	31	31	13	34	31	31	13	34	31	31	13	34	116	109	109	109	109
Net income	579	848	907	526	549	836	921	703	697	961	1,049	759	1,525	2,859	3,009	3,466	3,804
EPS, NT\$	1.64	2.40	2.56	1.49	1.55	2.36	2.60	1.99	1.97	2.72	2.97	2.15	4.31	8.08	8.51	9.80	10.75
Ratio analysis and assumption																	
As % of sales																	
Gross margin	31.9%	34.2%	34.4%	30.5%	30.2%	33.4%	34.0%	31.4%	31.0%	34.1%	34.5%	31.7%	28.8%	32.8%	32.3%	32.9%	33.2%
Operating expense ratio	22.1%	20.4%	19.4%	21.3%	20.0%	19.2%	18.8%	19.5%	18.8%	18.8%	18.4%	19.6%	22.0%	20.7%	19.4%	18.9%	19.0%
Operating margin	9.9%	13.8%	15.0%	9.2%	10.2%	14.2%	15.2%	11.9%	12.2%	15.3%	16.0%	12.1%	6.8%	12.1%	12.9%	14.0%	14.2%
Net margin	9.1%	11.3%	11.7%	7.6%	8.1%	11.5%	12.0%	9.5%	9.6%	12.4%	12.7%	9.6%	6.3%	10.0%	10.3%	11.1%	11.3%
QoQ growth (%)																	
Revenue	-2%	18%	3%	-10%	-2%	7%	6%	-3%	-2%	7%	6%	-5%					
Gross profit	16%	26%	4%	-20%	-3%	18%	7%	-11%	-3%	18%	8%	-12%					
Operating income	100%	64%	12%	-45%	8%	49%	13%	-24%	1%	34%	11%	-28%					
Net income	25%	46%	7%	-42%	4%	52%	10%	-24%	-1%	38%	9%	-28%					
YoY growth (%)																	
Revenue	9%	27%	29%	7%	7%	-3%	-1%	7%	7%	7%	8%	6%	-1%	18%	2%	7%	8%
Gross profit	17%	46%	55%	20%	1%	-6%	-2%	10%	10%	10%	10%	7%	-3%	34%	0%	9%	9%
OPEX	6%	21%	15%	3%	-3%	-9%	-4%	-2%	0%	5%	6%	7%	3%	11%	-5%	5%	9%
Operating income	50%	108%	183%	102%	10%	0%	0%	38%	29%	15%	14%	8%	-20%	111%	9%	16%	10%
Net income	20%	529%	104%	14%	-5%	-1%	2%	34%	27%	15%	14%	8%	-23%	87%	5%	15%	10%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis and Price Target Risks and Methodology**Investment thesis - Hiwin Corp**

Hiwin is the second-largest global linear motion supplier with 18% market share in 2024. It continues to witness decelerating market share growth from 2020 when it started to pursue a deleveraging strategy.

Although we expect Hiwin to continue to benefit from rising demand from the semiconductor/EV industry given the upgrading trend, we are Sell rated, given: (1) we expect a weak end-market demand recovery and high inventory levels for the near term, leading to high pricing pressure and a stagnant utilization rate; (2) continued overcapacity issues in mainland China, where the company has higher exposure (45% in 2024) vs peers such as THK (24%), and we expect this would lead to further deterioration in Hiwin's revenue/profitability outlook in the near term; and (3) the negative impact from its long-term deleveraging strategy. Hiwin continues to pay back long-term debt and expand capacity to better compete with peers, which we believe will further impact EPS growth and valuation. The stock is currently trading above its historical average valuation (33.0x). We expect its P/E multiple to derate once the market begins to adjust for a prolonged downcycle and expect downgrades to consensus EPS growth/ROE estimates, suggesting high downside risk to Hiwin's valuation.

Price target risks and methodology - Hiwin Corp

Valuation methodology: Our 12m TP of NT\$160 is based on a target P/E of 20x 4Q26-3Q27E EPS (in-line with Hiwin's average downcycle valuation, or 1std lower than the historical average P/E for the past 10 years).

Key upside risks: (1) Stronger-than-expected EV & semi CAPEX growth; (2) a favorable linear motion pricing environment in the coming quarters, with a positive supply-demand outlook or longer leadtime; and (3) a faster-than-expected machine tool demand recovery.

2049.TW	12m Price Target: NT\$160.00	Price: NT\$369.00	Downside: 56.6%
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Sell	GS Forecast				
Market cap: NT\$118.7bn / \$3.7bn Enterprise value: NT\$121.5bn / \$3.8bn 3m ADTV: NT\$1.8bn / \$57.4mn Taiwan Taiwan Electronic Components M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (NT\$ mn) New	24,262.6	28,567.0	29,133.6	31,209.7
	Revenue (NT\$ mn) Old	24,262.6	28,387.6	31,503.2	34,444.0
	EBITDA (NT\$ mn)	4,001.2	6,141.6	6,607.7	7,286.9
	EPS (NT\$) New	4.31	8.08	8.51	9.80
	EPS (NT\$) Old	4.31	6.72	8.51	10.22
	P/E (X)	53.7	45.7	43.4	37.7
	P/B (X)	2.2	3.3	NM	NM
	Dividend yield (%)	0.9	0.7	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	6.6	9.9	10.0	10.6
		6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
	EPS (NT\$)	2.40	2.56	1.49	1.55

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 12 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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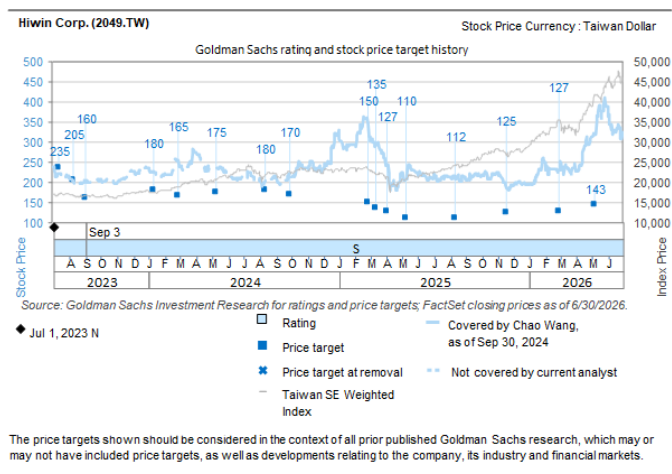
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Hiwin Corp. (2049.TW)

Date of report	Target price (NT\$)	Closing price (NT\$)
08-May-26	143.00	319.50
27-Feb-26	127.00	230.00
18-Nov-25	125.00	186.50
12-Aug-25	112.00	213.50
09-May-25	110.00	208.00
03-Apr-25	127.00	245.00
13-Mar-25	135.00	293.00
26-Feb-25	150.00	345.50
29-Sep-24	170.00	220.50
13-Aug-24	180.00	206.50
10-May-24	175.00	237.00
27-Feb-24	165.00	254.50
11-Jan-24	180.00	228.00
03-Sep-23	160.00	202.00

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